

Michelle R. Wilson

PAINTER

VANCOUVER, BC

BIOGRAPHY

Michelle R. Wilson is a Canadian painter based in Vancouver, BC. Her work moves across landscape, architectural studies, portraiture, and figurative painting, unified by a sustained inquiry into the relationship between self, spirit, and the world.

She came to painting early — introduced by her grandmother at age eight, during a childhood in Saskatchewan marked by serious illness. When asthma kept her indoors while other children played outside, painting became her portal: a way of inhabiting the world from within, of building an interior landscape when the exterior one remained out of reach. In this, she was not alone — her grandfather, on her father's side, was himself an artist, and his presence and practice quietly shaped the creative inheritance she carries. That early relationship between the body, the imagination, and the act of making has never fully left her work.

After years of painting classes and a deepening love of the craft, she pursued formal training in Studio Art at Capilano University, North Vancouver, BC, graduating in 2000. She has been based in Vancouver for over thirty years.

Her approach to painting is rooted in slowness, listening, and attention — a sensibility shaped by three decades of professional work at the intersection of human experience and care: twenty-five years in education and community living, holding space for people whose needs required genuine presence; and six years as a behavioural medicine health coach within primary healthcare, sitting with people through the slow, tender work of change. She works intuitively, allowing each piece to develop through a process of attention rather than intention.

Her influences include the contemplative traditions of meditation and inner stillness; a deep calling toward beauty, truth, and the natural world; and the experience of travel as a way of learning to see — all held within an enduring inquiry into what it means to be fully present to this human life.

Her earlier bodies of work include figure and portrait studies, a series of Paris cityscapes, paintings of dancers in motion, and home portraits. Her current work — including the series *Returning* and her ongoing *Home Portraits* — moves between landscape and architecture, exploring how the spaces we inhabit hold memory, offer shelter, and quietly shape our sense of belonging. These works sit with a quietly philosophical question: what does it mean to feel held by a place — by the earth beneath it, and the walls we raise from it?

Her paintings are held in private collections across Canada and the United States. She accepts commissions across all subjects and is available for collaboration with interior, architectural, and curatorial projects.

Updated May 2026

Michelle R. Wilson

PAINTER

VANCOUVER, BC

C V

EDUCATION

2000 Studio Art, Capilano University, North Vancouver, BC

Self-taught foundation beginning age 8; formal training at Capilano University

EXHIBITIONS

Solo

2015 Paris, Art and Fashion Collaboration, Lüt Boutique, Vancouver, BC

2011 Form, The Whip Gallery Restaurant, Vancouver, BC

2005 Portrait Studies, Art Gallery of Regina, Regina, SK

2003 Solo Exhibition, Bushwacker Restaurant Gallery, Regina, SK

Group

2005 Art Gallery of Regina, Regina, SK

2004–2005 La Bodega Restaurant Gallery, Regina, SK

2002 Waterfall Gallery, Vancouver, BC

2002 Studio Blue, Vancouver, BC

SELECTED COMMISSIONS

2026 Florence Landscape, private commission, White City, SK

2026 Home Portrait, private commission, Fort Lauderdale, FL

2020 Coastal Pastoral, private commission, Toronto, ON

2016 Pacific Shore Landscape, private commission, Sunshine Coast, BC

2008 Parental Portraits, private commission, Regina, SK

2007 Child Portraits, private commission, Moose Jaw, SK

2006 Johnny Cash (portrait), private commission, Edmonton, AB

2004 Audrey Hepburn and Johnny Depp (portraits), private commission, Regina, SK

COLLECTIONS

Private collections across Canada and the United States.

PRESS

2015 “Fashion & Art Converge at Lüt,” *Vancouver Is Awesome*